MONTHLY UPDATE

New investments: monthly update, July 2026

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26 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Angola

The digital acceleration project acquired published targets for the first time. At its third steering committee on 30 July it was stated to be contracted to reach ten million people by March 2030, lifting broadband users from a stated baseline of 14,743,807 to 19.7 million and getting 400 firms onto green digital products, on US$300m of financing whose terms are a market-rate loan rather than concessional finance.

Benin

One commitment entered the window. During a ministerial visit of 4 to 6 August, Canada announced CAD5m for the digital transformation of women-led businesses, one of seven projects in a package of about CAD17m for Benin and West Africa. The remaining six lines are outside the digital estate. What the digital line does not carry is an implementing partner, a start date or a duration, so there is nothing yet to follow from the announcement to a system.

Burkina Faso

A digital acceleration project stated on 13 July that it will support connectivity to 1,000 localities in 2026 against nearly 2,000 still without mobile or internet service, expected to benefit one and a half to two million people, most of them rural. No regulator or ministry primary states whether that count is of telecom sites or of localities served.

Chad

The digital transformation project shows US$12,220,932 disbursed and three thousand electronic payment terminals handed to the finance ministry, with about 500 unserved localities named as the outstanding challenge. Its envelope is carried as FCFA 76.45bn in one source and US$92.2m in another — the first close to total project cost, the second to the grant alone — and no source reconciles them. A further programme of about FCFA 8bn sits at pipeline stage, 90 per cent externally committed with a closing date of 31 January 2029, covering electronic tax, standardised electronic invoicing, customs upgrades, tax teleservice centres and one-stop-shop interconnection. It is an aid-transparency record, not a signed instrument.

Congo

The European phase of the transformation project, launched in June 2025 with EUR 36.3m of loan and FCFA 10bn of grant committed, made its first named procurement in July — the same 24-month cybersecurity mission — with no procurement held before now.

DR Congo

A development fund committed US$32.8m into an upsized US$179m senior secured facility on 5 August, funding 728 new passive towers to take the network to 1,800, 70% of them rural, with solar and battery upgrades. The same lender committed US$30m to the same borrower in 2023, when the network stood at 1,072 active towers.

Egypt

The data-centre position moved by cancellation. Telecom Egypt's board withdrew on 17 July from the agreement to sell 75-80% of its Regional Data Center Hub because the conditions were not met; the hub is instead to be carved out as a wholly-owned subsidiary (cancellation account). Neither the consideration nor the unmet conditions were disclosed.

Eswatini

The month's largest item is the financing: the ICT ministry's first-quarter performance report established that Eswatini has secured approval for more than E1.06bn in World Bank financing for the Digital Eswatini Project, converted in the source at E16.37 to the dollar on 19 July 2026.

Ethiopia

A US$300,000 grant was committed on 31 July for 2026 to 2028, converting a catalytic start-up initiative into a longer programme delivering agricultural extension services through digital channels.

Ghana

Parliament approved a twenty-year public-private toll concession on 31 July for nationwide fully electronic collection, through a special-purpose vehicle to be established by a named company. No concession value, revenue split, corridor count, build timetable or collection technology is stated. A national financial-technology fund remains to be aligned with a forthcoming innovation and startup framework that would set eligibility and give it a legal basis; no size, source of funds or date is given.

Guinea

The month's one clear statement about money is the WARDIP terms of reference, naming IDA Credit No. 74440GN and the US$60m financing behind it — the first document on file tying a Guinean digital programme to a credit reference.

Kenya

Two financings were signed. A EUR270m facility across 21 obligors in eight jurisdictions was signed on 9 July, its committed portion of up to EUR170m including a local-currency tranche of up to EUR20m equivalent in shillings for fibre modernisation in Kenya, with a further uncommitted EUR100m for future acquisitions and capital expenditure across the lender's sub-Saharan operations. Domestically the digital economy acceleration project took KSh 4.3bn for the year, half the entire digital thematic, to equip more than 10,000 junior secondary schools.

On 4 August the development lender committed US$24.2m across three Kenyan lenders under the first catalytic first-loss guarantee transactions anywhere in Africa, backed by US$11m of concessional private-sector-window money and expected to catalyse about US$144.4m of local-currency lending to micro-enterprises. Only one of the three counterparties is a digital lender; the individual allocations are not disclosed, so what the structure buys in fintech terms cannot be read off the announcement.

Liberia

The finance minister put the youth entrepreneurship investment bank at almost US$18m targeting 30,000 youth-led businesses and about 100,000 jobs, with a national coordinator recruited and a board being constituted. No disbursement is stated.

Malawi

The governance and service delivery project closed on 30 June, its grant mechanism continuing under a successor. No closing disbursement figure or results statement is held.

Mali

On 22 July the universal access fund signed two four-year renewable conventions with the education ministry and the entrepreneurship, employment and vocational training ministry, committing it to connect every secondary, technical and vocational school by end-2027, with more than 80 new universal access centres, 100 new Cases Wi-Fi and cumulative education spend put above FCFA 17bn.

Morocco

The ministry stated on 22 July that the digital transformation acceleration programme, approved and signed in June 2026, is backed by US$250m over five years, and that bringing it into force before 23 September 2026 was its immediate priority (ministry account). The programme was not in force at 6 August.

A corporate venture fund of US$250m, writing cheques of up to US$5m into regional start-ups, was reported operating on 2 August, the figure attributed by the reporting outlet to a third-party tracker rather than to any Moroccan disclosure (tracker account).

Mozambique

The digital foundations programme runs to 2027 with the European Union delegation funding and the telecommunications union implementing. It reports a national digital skills assessment drawing on more than 30 interviews and a survey of about 400 young people, a Matola pilot training 50 young people and 5 teachers, 15 women trained under a govtech challenge, more than 100 participants in artificial-intelligence training for young women and more than 320 stakeholders reached by accessibility work. The project page is undated and rolling, so none of those outputs can be placed inside this window, and no disbursement update is held.

Nigeria

A Lagos fibre operator closed the ₦4.05bn first tranche of a ₦20bn programme in the domestic bond market on 27 July. It is long-dated local capital in a market whose rates push savings to short maturities.

Domestic retail investors traded ₦2.86tn of equities between January and May, up 138.76% year on year and 36.22% of activity, against ₦4.06tn institutional. Participants name the registrar layer as the operational failure that matters: shareholder names are recorded inconsistently, and dividend payment is delayed behind it.

A credit-scoring business scores people without bank accounts from their payment patterns and sells the output to banks, treating everyday transactional behaviour as the credit file — which extends access to people without bank accounts and makes payment data an underwriting input. Consent, purpose limitation and whether an automated refusal can be contested are not addressed in anything held.

A US$110m debt facility for technology startups opened for applications on 30 July.

Sao Tome and Principe

UNICEF's tender for school ICT equipment, opened 30 July 2026 against grant SC220341, is the month's only new financing activity in this section; no contract value was stated, since bidders price the supply themselves, and the tender does not disclose the total size of the grant it draws on.

Senegal

A US$50m pre-seed and seed fund was announced on a conference stage in Paris on 20 June, with public capital framed as crowding in private investors. No first close, limited partners, fund manager or deployment is held.

Sierra Leone

The same statement — reporting the academic Digital Public Goods exhibition — also gives the Sierra Leone Innovation Investment Fund a target of US$150m over five years, with no amount raised.

South Africa

One programme opened in the window, and it is not yet a commitment to anybody. On 11 August the United Kingdom published an expression-of-interest call for a Southern Africa science and technology accelerator worth up to GBP2.5m over three years to March 2030, with up to GBP400,000 for 2026/27, covering artificial intelligence and emerging technologies and digital access alongside climate, energy, health and space. South Africa is the primary focus and Zimbabwe and Zambia the first year's. The fund is resourced and the delivery consortium is not chosen, so what the money buys is a matter for a contract expected later in the year.

Togo

A further US$20,000,000 was signed for the Togolese component of the regional unique identification programme on 16 July, inside a five-agreement package of US$429,000,000. The implementation report the base holds gives that phase a closing date of 30 July 2026 and nothing restates or extends it alongside the top-up. A public administration service-delivery modernisation project was named at the government's portfolio review of 28 July as the digitalisation vehicle inside a portfolio of more than US$2bn; the base holds the name and nothing else.

Uganda

The digital acceleration project is named as funder of the Tororo, Mbarara and Gulu service-centre pilots and as the affordable-connectivity vehicle. No disbursement figure is held for it.

Zambia

On 27 July a domestic digital lender reported more than K500 million lent to over 120,000 customers since founding, and committed a further K500 million over the next decade — a forward intention by the lender itself, with no external financier named.

External money made a smaller and vaguer offer. On 11 August the United Kingdom opened expressions of interest for a Southern Africa science and technology accelerator worth up to GBP2.5m to March 2030, naming Zambia with Zimbabwe as the first year's focus and South Africa as the programme's primary one. No Zambian allocation is stated, and the delivery consortium has not been chosen.

Zimbabwe

The ICT minister also committed on 29 July to ring-fencing a share of the universal services fund for public-good artificial-intelligence projects, stating no amount (launch account).

Two external commitments arrived in August, and only one of them has a number attached to Zimbabwe. A United Nations contract award of 10 August puts US$5,947,948 into the supply of ICT equipment to the country — an exact figure against a purpose stated as nothing more than ICT equipment, with neither the receiving government body nor the awarded vendor named. The United Kingdom separately opened expressions of interest for a Southern Africa science and technology accelerator worth up to GBP2.5m to March 2030, naming Zimbabwe and Zambia as its first year's focus with South Africa the primary one. No Zimbabwean allocation is stated and no delivery consortium has been chosen.

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